

Employee Handbook

Version 3.2 · Effective 1 January 2026 · Applies to all full-time employees

1. Welcome

Brightpath Studio is a product design and engineering company with offices in Dubai Internet City and Lisbon. This handbook applies to all full-time employees. Contractors should refer to their individual agreements.

2. Working Hours

Core hours are **10:00 to 15:00** Gulf Standard Time, Sunday to Thursday for the Dubai office and Monday to Friday for the Lisbon office. Outside core hours employees organise their day flexibly, as long as they work 40 hours per week.

Overtime must be approved in advance by your team lead. Approved overtime is compensated with time off in lieu at **1.5 hours for every hour** worked.

3. Remote Work

Employees may work remotely up to **2 days per week**. Tuesdays are in-office days for all teams so that planning and design reviews happen in person.

Fully remote arrangements are possible after 6 months of employment and require approval from both the team lead and the Head of People.

The company provides a one-time home office allowance of **AED 1,500** for a desk, chair or monitor. Receipts must be submitted within 60 days of purchase.

4. Annual Leave

Full-time employees receive **25 working days** of paid annual leave per year, plus UAE public holidays. Leave accrues monthly. Up to **5 unused days** can be carried over to the next year; carried-over days expire on **31 March**.

Leave requests of 5 days or more must be submitted at least 4 weeks in advance through the HR portal. Shorter requests need 1 week notice.

5. Sick Leave

Employees receive **15 days of fully paid sick leave** per year. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than **2 consecutive days**. Inform your team lead before 10:00 on the first day of absence.

6. Parental Leave

Primary caregivers receive **60 days** of paid parental leave. Secondary caregivers receive **10 days**, which can be taken within 6 months of the birth or adoption.

7. Public Holidays

The Dubai office follows the official UAE public holiday calendar announced each year. The Lisbon office follows Portuguese national holidays.

Fictional sample document created for the DocChat demo. Any resemblance to real organisations is coincidental.

8. Expenses

Business expenses must be submitted through the Expenses app within **30 days**, with a photo of the receipt.

Who approves an expense claim depends on the amount:

- Claims **under AED 750** are approved by your **team lead**.
- Claims **from AED 750 to AED 5,000** are approved by the **Finance Manager**.
- Claims **over AED 5,000** need approval from both the **Finance Manager and the Managing Director**.

9. Business Travel

Flights under 6 hours are booked in economy class; flights of 6 hours or more may be booked in premium economy. The hotel allowance is up to **AED 650 per night**. Meals during travel are covered up to **AED 220 per day**.

All travel must be booked through the company travel desk at least 10 days before departure, except for urgent client visits approved by the Managing Director.

10. Learning Budget

Every employee has an annual learning budget of **AED 5,500** for courses, books, certifications and conferences. Unused budget does not carry over. Requests over AED 1,800 need team lead approval.

11. Equipment

New employees receive a laptop (MacBook Pro or a Windows equivalent), a 27-inch monitor for the office, and a headset. Equipment remains company property and must be returned on the last working day.

12. Code of Conduct

We expect respectful, honest behaviour toward colleagues, clients and partners. Harassment or discrimination of any kind is not tolerated and can be reported confidentially to the Head of People.

13. Contacts

Topic	Contact
Leave, contracts, wellbeing	Sara Haddad, Head of People · people@brightpath.example
Expenses and payroll	Tomas Ribeiro, Finance Manager · finance@brightpath.example
Laptops, accounts, security	IT Help Desk · it-help@brightpath.example · ext. 400

This is version 3.2 of the handbook, effective 1 January 2026. It replaces all earlier versions.